

VISHAL VELLAISAMY

Intern + FTE in TEJAS NETWORKS

About the Company

Tejas Networks is an Indian R&D organization developing cutting-edge optical and data networking products for India and the world. Founded in 2000, it is the only Indian homegrown electronic hardware design company to achieve many firsts, such as successfully demonstrating hitless LCAS on Ethernet hardware and running 100G interfaces over FPGAs, now deployed globally. As the #1 optical aggregation provider in India and among the top 10 globally, Tejas has pioneered the “Make in India” initiative by not only designing but also manufacturing its innovative products domestically. This has been made possible by an energetic and dedicated team of engineers for whom no problem is unsolvable.

Tejas’ R&D organization delivers a diverse portfolio of Access, Edge, and Switching products supporting Broadband, Mobile Backhaul, Enterprise, Utilities, Fixed Wireless, and SDN applications across the access, metro, and core network tiers. With over 500 networks in 75+ countries, the company has earned global trust. In April 2022, Tata Sons, through Panatone Finvest Limited, acquired a majority stake of 52.45%, further strengthening Tejas’ position as a global leader in telecommunications. Tejas Networks continues to lead with innovation, customer-centric solutions, and a commitment to quality.

About the role

- ☐ Designation - Engineer, R&D
- ☐ Experience – Fresher.
- ☐ Location – Chennai.
- ☐ Object Oriented Analysis and Design.
- ☐ Data Structures, Algorithms and their complexity/performance.
- ☐ Design/development/debugging in Java.
- ☐ Middleware like Hibernate, ActiveMQ & Relational DBs like MySQL/Oracle.
- ☐ Familiarity with Software Defined Networking (SDN) concepts, and SDN controllers like ODL or ONOS is desirable. Good to have: NMS/EMS/OSS/BSS domain experience.

Selection Process

1.Coding Round

The test was conducted on the **Pro Hire** platform, which was smooth and user-friendly. One notable aspect was that there was **no camera proctoring** during the test, allowing for a more comfortable experience. This round was a mix of aptitude and coding questions, designed to challenge both logical thinking and problem-solving abilities. The coding section consisted of three problems of varying difficulty, covering a range of algorithmic and programming concepts.

2.First Technical Round

This round focused on assessing my foundational knowledge and understanding my projects. The interviewer asked a variety of questions that allowed me to showcase my technical expertise. Some of the key questions included:

- **Tell me about yourself.**
- **Explain your projects in detail.**
- Questions related to **networking** in one of my projects.
- Questions about **OOP concepts**, including the **pillars of OOP** and writing example programs for them.
- **A basic programming question** on solving **2-sum and 3-sum problems**.
- **Apart from academics, what do you do?** (I mentioned being a part of **AUSEC** - Anna University Student Entrepreneurship Club, as listed in my resume.)

3.Second Technical Round

This round focused on problem-solving skills and included a mix of technical and programming questions. Key questions included:

- **Tell me about yourself.**
- **Rate your skills** out of ten in Python, Java, and SQL.
- A graph-based question: **Island and River problem**.
- A tree-based question: **BFS tree traversal problem**.
- An SQL query question involving **joins**.

4.HR Round

This round was light and conversational, aimed at understanding my aspirations, communication skills, and cultural fit within the organization. Some of the key questions asked were:

- **What do you know about Tejas Networks?**
- **Why Tejas Networks?**
- **What will you gain from Tejas, and how will you contribute if hired?**

5.Managerial Round

This round was designed to test my situational judgment and management skills. The questions were focused on how I handle responsibilities and challenges as a team player. Some of the key questions included:

- **What will you do in a critical situation where the client gives you less time to complete the work? How will you manage?**
- **What will you do if your teammate is not doing their work properly?**
- **What working environment do you prefer and why?**
- **What is the most complex situation you have faced, and how did you overcome it?**

Tips and Suggestions from Me:

1. Let the interviewer know if you have experience working with any networking tools. It doesn't necessarily mean you need to have done a project on it, but having one is a plus. In my case, I had done assignments using the NS3 simulator and Wireshark.
2. It's not 100% about solving the problem or providing the exact right output. What matters more is how you handle the situation, even if you can't solve it.
3. Be confident and polite throughout the interview.
4. If you don't know the answer, let the interviewer know by saying, "I'm not sure, but I can learn it in the future."
5. During the selection process (after the coding round), I noticed that most candidates had similar technical skills. What helped me stand out was my contributions to clubs and event organizations.
6. Lastly, you also need that 1% luck!
7. Adding a 7th tip just because **Thala** for a reason – **All the best!**

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